



Setting Boundaries With Yourself

How to stop breaking your own no-contact rule

digitaldisconnect.shop/guides/setting-boundaries-with-yourself-no-contact

You set the rule. You meant it. And then, again, you checked, liked or texted. If you're stuck in that cycle, you're negotiating with yourself, and the part of you that wants contact keeps winning. The fix isn't more guilt. It's clearer boundaries with yourself.

Why the cycle repeats

- The rule is vague ("I'll try not to") so every moment becomes a new decision.
- The urge arrives when you're tired, lonely or drinking, the moments you're least equipped for.
- You treat a slip as proof you can't do it, so you give up for the day.
- Part of you is still hoping contact will fix the pain.

Write the boundary down, specifically

A boundary with yourself works best when it's concrete. Instead of "I won't text them," try:

- "I don't initiate contact for 30 days, unless it's about the lease."
- "I don't look at their profile. If I want to, I write down what I hoped to see."
- "After 10pm my phone stays in the kitchen."

Pre-decide your hardest moments

Look back at your last three slips. When were they? What were you doing? Write an "if-then" plan for each: "If it's Friday night and I've been drinking, then I give my phone to a friend or leave it at home." Deciding ahead of time takes the decision out of the moment.

Listen to the part of you that wants contact

The urge usually wants something reasonable: comfort, closure, reassurance, company. Ask it directly in writing: "What do you need right now?" Then find another way to meet that need. You can't out-argue a need, but you can meet it.

Self-compassion keeps you going

Being harsh with yourself after a slip tends to make the next slip more likely. Treat yourself like a friend who's trying: acknowledge it, learn from it, restart. A streak counter and a short daily check-in help you see progress rather than just failures.

YOUR NOTES

What I'm taking from this guide

NEXT STEP

Put it into practice for 30 days.

The No-Contact Journal is a printable 30-day guided journal: 90 prompts, a daily no-contact check-in, and a "Before you text them" page for the moments you're about to reach out.

Get it at digitaldisconnect.shop

Or start free with the 3-day starter at digitaldisconnect.shop/free

This guide is general self-help information, not therapy, medical or legal advice. If you're thinking about harming yourself, in the US call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or contact your local emergency number.

© The No-Contact Journal · Free to share in full with credit.